

Chapter-2

Bio-Sketch

A bio-sketch or biographical sketch is a brief but formal piece of writing. It is the description of a person's life including all the significant aspects such as birth, family, education, occupation, achievements, social status, death (if the person is no more). All the major events are described along with important dates or years. It may be the description of a celebrity or a common person. It is a brief description in about 100 words, although the word limit may vary according to the notes provided for the description. The key events along with the dates are provided in the question.

Important Points for writing a Bio-Sketch

1. Date and Place of Birth
2. Name and occupation of parents
3. Early childhood and schooling
4. Educational Qualification, College, University
5. Hobbies/Interests
6. Educational Achievements
7. Profession/Occupation
8. Major Achievements along with dates
9. Personal life
10. Social status
11. Awards/Honours
12. Date and cause of Death

Bio-Sketch Sample-1

Read the following notes written on the famous playback singer Lata Mangeshkar. Taking help from the notes, write a bio-sketch of Lata Mangeshkar.

Name: Lata Mangeshkar, Date of birth: 28 September 1929, Place of birth: Indore, Madhya Pradesh

Occupation: Playback singer, music director, producer

Parents: Pandit Deenanath Mangeshkar (Marathi father), classical singer and theatre actor

Shevanti Mangeshkar (Gujrati mother)

Siblings: Asha Bhosle, Hridaynath Mangeshkar, Usha Mangeshkar, Meena Mangeshkar
Asha, Lata: eldest, started working at the age of five in father's musical plays

First song: at the age of 13

Other names: Queen of Melody, Voice of the Nation, Voice of the Millennium, Nightingale of India

Awards: Three National Film Awards, 15 Bengali Film

Journalists' Association Awards, Four Filmfare Best Female Playback Awards, two Filmfare Special Awards, Filmfare Life Achievement Award

Honours: Padma Bhushan 1969, Dadasaheb Phalke Award 1989, Padma Vibhushan 1999, Bharat Ratna 2001, Leign of Honour 2007



Lata Mangeshkar, one of the best Indian playback singers and music director, was born to Marathi Father, Pandit Deenanath Mangeshkar and Gujarati Mother, Shevanti Mangeshkar on 28th September, 1929 at Indore in Madhya Pradesh. She is the eldest child of her parents with three sisters Asha Bhosle, Usha Mangeshkar and Meena Mangeshkar, and a brother Hridaynath Mangeshkar. She received her first music lesson from her father. She started working in father's musical plays at the age of five. She recorded her first song at the age of 13. She is the recipient of three National Film Awards, 15 Bengali Film Journalists' Association Awards, Four Filmfare Best Female Playback Awards, two Filmfare Special Awards, Filmfare Life Achievement Award. She was honoured with Padma Bhushan in 1969, Dadasaheb Phalke Award in 1989, Padma Vibhushan in 1999, Bharat Ratna in 2001, and Leign of Honour in 2007. It is due to her melodious voice and great contribution to Indian music industry that she is rightfully known as Queen of Melody, Voice of the Nation, Voice of the Millennium, and Nightingale of India.

Bio-Sketch Sample-2

Read the following notes written on the famous astronaut Kalpana Chawla. Based on the facts provided, write a bio-sketch of Kalpana Chawla.

Name: Kalpana Chawla, first Indian born woman in space

Date of birth: 17 March, 1962, youngest of four children

Official Date of Birth: 1 July, 1961, to allow her to become eligible for matriculation examination

Place of birth: Karnal, Haryana

Education: Bachelor of Engineering in Aeronautical Engineering from Punjab Engineering College

Moved to USA in 1982, Master of Science degree in Aerospace Engineering from the University of Texas at Arlington in 1984, second Masters in 1986 and a PhD in aerospace engineering in 1988 from the University of Colorado Boulder.

Career: In 1988, began working at NASA where she did computational fluid dynamics (CFD) research on vertical and/or short take-off and landing (V/STOL) concepts, held a Certificated Flight Instructor rating for airplanes, gliders and Commercial Pilot licenses for single and multi-engine airplanes, seaplanes and gliders, naturalized U.S. citizenship in April 1991, applied for the NASA Astronaut Corps, joined the corps in March 1995, selected for her first flight in 1996.

First space mission : November 17, 1997, as part of the six-astronaut crew that flew the Space Shuttle Columbia flight STS-87, the first Indian woman to fly in space

In 2000, selected for her second flight as part of the crew of space shuttle Columbia on the ill fated flight STS-107.

Death: Space Shuttle Columbia disaster on February 1, 2003, killed along with the other six crew members, when the Columbia disintegrated over Texas during re-entry into the Earth's atmosphere



The first Indian-born woman in space, Kalpana Chawla was born on March 17, 1962 at Karnal, Haryana, but her official date of birth was altered to 1 July 1961 to allow her to become eligible for the matriculation exam. She was the youngest of four children. After getting a Bachelor of Engineering degree in Aeronautical Engineering from Punjab Engineering College, India, she moved to the United States in 1982 and obtained a Master of Science degree in Aerospace Engineering from the University of Texas at Arlington in 1984. Chawla earned a second Masters in 1986 and a PhD in aerospace engineering in 1988 from the University of Colorado Boulder. In 1988, she began working at NASA, where she did computational fluid dynamics (CFD) research on vertical and/or short take-off and landing (V/STOL) concepts. Chawla held a Certificated Flight Instructor rating for airplanes, gliders and Commercial Pilot licenses for single and multi-engine airplanes, seaplanes and gliders. After becoming a naturalized U.S. citizen in April 1991, she applied for the NASA Astronaut Corps. She joined the corps in March 1995 and was selected for her first flight in 1996. Her first space mission began on November 17, 1997, as part of the six-astronaut crew that flew the Space Shuttle Columbia flight STS-87. Chawla was the first Indian woman to fly in space. In 2000, Chawla was selected for her second flight as part of the crew of flight STS-107 of the space shuttle Columbia. Chawla died in the Space Shuttle Columbia disaster which occurred on February 1, 2003; she was killed, along with the other six crew members, when the Columbia disintegrated over Texas during re-entry into the Earth's atmosphere.



Referred to as the Shahenshah of Bollywood, Sadi ka Mahanayak, Star of the Millennium

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Name: Albert Einstein, German-born theoretical physicist
Date of Birth: 14 March 1879, Place of Birth: in Ulm, in the Kingdom of Württemberg in the German Empire,
Father: Hermann Einstein, a salesman and engineer Mother: Pauline Koch.
Learnt algebra and Euclidean geometry over a single summer, also independently discovered his own original proof of the Pythagorean theorem at age 12, mastered integral and differential calculus by 14,
In 1900, Einstein's paper "Conclusions from the Capillarity Phenomena" published in the journal Annalen der Physik, awarded a Ph.D by the University of Zürich, with his dissertation "A New Determination of Molecular Dimensions", same year, published four groundbreaking papers, on the photoelectric effect, Brownian motion, special relativity, and the equivalence of mass and energy making him famous in the academic world, at the age of 26, his mass–energy equivalence formula $E = mc^2$ dubbed "the world's most famous equation"
became a full professor at the German Charles-Ferdinand University in Prague in April 1911
Nobel Prize in Physics 1921
On 17 April 1955, Einstein experienced internal bleeding caused by the rupture of an abdominal aortic aneurysm, He died in Princeton Hospital on 18 April 1955 early morning at the age of 76.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines, typical of primary school writing paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Name: Bhagat Singh, one of the most influential revolutionaries of the Indian Independence Movement, often referred to as Shaheed Bhagat Singh,
Date of Birth: September/October 1907
Place of Birth: Banga, Punjab, British India, Now in Punjab, Pakistan
Parents: Kishan Singh and Vidyawati
Early schooling: Dayanand Anglo-Vedic High School, an Arya Samaji institution.
College: 1923, National College, Lahore
Founded Naujawan Bharat Sabha in March 1926, also joined the Hindustan Republican Association
In December 1928, Bhagat Singh and an associate, Shivaram Rajguru, fatally shot a 21-year-old British police officer, John Saunders, in Lahore, British India, mistaking Saunders for the British police superintendent, James Scott, whom they had intended to assassinate to avenge Lala Lajpat Rai's death as a result of lathi charge
April 1929, he and another associate, Batukeshwar Dutt, exploded two improvised bombs inside the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi, got arrested, waited for trial
Convicted and hanged on March 23, 1931, aged 23.

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Name: Kapil Dev Nikhanj, famous Indian Cricketer,
Date of birth: January 6, 1959, Place of Birth: Chandigarh
Parents: Ram Lal Nikhanj, a prominent timber merchant and his wife Raj Kumari
Wife: Romi Bhatia in 1980, daughter, Amiya Dev,
Career: Made impressive debut for Haryana in November 1975 against Punjab with a 06 wicket haul, won his maiden and only Ranji Trophy championship in 1991, first player to take 200 ODI wickets, the only player in the history of cricket to have taken more than 400 wickets (434 wickets) and scored more than 5000 runs in Tests, one of the greatest all-rounders to have played the game, Captained the Indian cricket team that won the 1983 Cricket World Cup, retired in 1994, holding the world record for the most number of wickets taken in Test cricket, India's national cricket coach between October 1999 and August 2000.
Awards: 1979–80 – Arjuna Award, 1982 – Padma Shri, 1983 – Wisden Cricketer of the Year, 1991 – Padma Bhushan, 2002 – Wisden Indian Cricketer of the Century, 2010 – ICC Cricket Hall of Fame, 2013 – The 25 Greatest Global Living Legends In India by NDTV, 2013 – CK Nayudu Lifetime Achievement award, Honour: 2008, Lieutenant Colonel, Indian Territorial Army

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